XYZ - Technology Services

IT Service Level Management Procedure

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1. Introduction

1.1 Purpose

The IT Service Level Management procedure aims to establish standardized processes to identify, analyze, define, implement, and monitor IT services that enable secure, reliable, effective, and efficient business operations and a superior user experience.

1.2 Scope

The IT Service Level Management procedure applies to XYZ Holdings IT management and staff, temporary IT employees, and third parties contracted to provide IT service to XYZ Holdings (hereinafter referred to as IT Employees). The scope of this procedure includes all IT Services provided by Technology Services.

1.3 Responsibility

The Chief Digital Officer (CDO) shall be accountable for the effective review, approval, communication, implementation, and adoption of the IT Service Level Management Procedure and all changes to the procedure.

The Head of Infrastructure and Support shall own and be responsible for the accuracy and maintenance of this procedure as well as its effective communication and implementation.

All IT Employees across XYZ Holdings shall be responsible for the effective adoption and implementation of this IT Service Level Management Procedure.

1.4 Laws and Regulations

This IT Service Level Management procedure shall conform to the legal and regulatory requirements of [coun and any other country where XYZ Holdings conducts its business operations. These include "The Computer Crimes Act 24 of 2007 of [coun and any other laws and regulations that may apply for the protection and preservation of individuals' rights and organizational information assets.

1.5 Procedure Implementation

This IT Service Level Management procedure shall be implemented through the execution of underpinning contracts with Vendors/ Service Providers, engagement of key business unit management in defining and formalizing service expectations, and the deployment of the "SysAid" IT Helpdesk System. IT management and employees across XYZ Holdings shall support the implementation of IT Service Level Management procedures and associated processes and practices.

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1.6 Compliance

- Systems and services provided by XYZ-TS are the property of XYZ-TS. This gives XYZ-TS the right to monitor all activities performed using these resources.
- Users shall maintain continued compliance with all XYZ-TS policies, procedures, guidelines, rules, and administrative orders while using XYZ-TS systems, facilities, and/or services.
- The Chief Digital Officer shall designate persons to perform periodic reviews and provide relevant feedback on the design and operating effectiveness of this procedure.
- Non-compliance to this procedure shall be recorded and responded to through the Incident and Problem Management procedure.
- If XYZ-TS discovers or has good reason to suspect activities that do not comply with applicable laws or policies, activity logs or records may be retrieved and used/ presented as evidence for disciplinary action against the involved user.

1.7 Review and Revision

- This IT Service Level Management Procedure shall be periodically reviewed and updated to reflect changes in the organization, operating environment, local laws and regulations, and leading practices as well as recommendations provided by consultants/ advisors, and internal and external auditors.
- The procedure review and revision period shall not exceed one Calendar year.

1.8 Glossary of Terms

This procedure uses the following terms in the given context:

Term	*Description*
Confidentiality	Confidentiality is a characteristic that applies to information. To protect and preserve the confidentiality of information means to ensure that it is not made available or disclosed to unauthorized entities. In this context, entities include individuals, processes, and systems.
Event	An event can be defined as any detectable occurrence that has significance for the management of the IT Infrastructure or the delivery of IT service.
Information Asset	An information Asset is a definable piece of information, stored in any manner that is recognized as 'valuable' to the organization or a Sensitive System that contains such valuable information.

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Information Security	Information security is the protection of information from a wide range of threats to ensure business continuity, minimize business risk, and maximize return on investment and business opportunities.
Incident	An unplanned interruption to an IT service or a reduction/ failure to meet agreed service levels or in the case of information security incidents, indicates that the security of an information system, service, or network may have been breached or compromised. An information security incident may also indicate that an information security policy may have been violated or a safeguard may have failed.
IT Helpdesk	IT Helpdesk is implemented to provide a single point of contact to meet the communication needs of both IT Service Users and IT employees. The purpose of the IT Helpdesk is to assist users, provide guidance about IT services, troubleshoot user issues, and capture new user requirements.
IT Service	An information technology-related service provided to one or more Customers/ Users, by an IT Service Provider that supports the Customer's/ User's Business Processes. An IT Service is made up of a combination of people, Processes, and technology components.

Term	*Description*
Operational Level Agreement (OLA)	An internal agreement between an IT Service Provider's division, departments/ sections that support the delivery of IT Services to the Customers/ Users. The OLA defines the goods or Services to be provided and the responsibilities of each party.
Risk	Combination of the probability of an unwanted event and its consequence/ impact.
Service Level Agreement (SLA)	An agreement between the IT Service Provider and a Customer/ User that documents the Service Level Targets, and specifies the responsibilities of the IT Service Provider and the Customer / User.

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Underpinning Contract	A contract with an external supplier/ service provider covering the delivery of goods and/ or services that contribute towards the delivery of IT services to customers/ users. The terms and conditions of the underpinning contract should reflect/ be reflected in the respective Service Level Agreements (SLAs).

2. Service Catalogue

- Central IT sourcing validates agreements in conjunction with XYZ group Legal with all vendors/suppliers before entering into SLA.
- The TS Sourcing team will establish a service catalog that defines all the services provided by third-party service providers (Service Level Catalog_ Enter document name).
- The service catalog will be maintained and updated by the Central IT sourcing division.
- The service catalog will include information such as the following:
    - Name of the service
    - Service Level Targets
    - Contacts
    - Service hours and exceptions and
    - Security arrangements, etc.
- The Head of Infrastructure and Support will review the service catalogs on an annual basis to ensure that they remain appropriate and up to date.

3. Service Level Agreement (SLA)

Central IT Sourcing Division will formally establish, external SLAs for services received by XYZ Holdings from vendors/Suppliers.

The external SLAs will contain the following as applicable:

- SLA overview which includes the parties involved and the purpose of the SLA.
- **Description of services** e.g., Systems supported, services included, services NOT included, and how the service will be delivered.
- Supported Systems provides a detailed list of all information systems or IT infrastructure included within the scope of the agreement.
- Services Included comprehensively outline the specific services the SLA covers. This may include system management, application support, data center services, etc.

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- Services Excluded explicitly define any services not included within the scope of the SLA, ensuring a clear understanding of service boundaries.
- Service Delivery Method describes how services will be delivered, outlining the third party's communication channels and support models.
- The validity period, or the start and end dates of the SLA, usually remain in effect until a new agreement is signed.
- Termination outlines conditions under which either party can terminate the agreement, along with any associated notification requirements.
- Service performance will be used to monitor/ track and report on the service provider's performance.
- Performance Metrics define specific, measurable performance metrics aligned with the previously defined SLAs. These metrics will assess the third party's adherence to the agreed-upon service levels. The supporting services on which the delivered service depends will be documented and agreed upon with each third party. This includes internal groups providing part of the third-party's service.
- The contents are formally agreed upon and authorized by business owners and third-party representatives and communicated to all affected parties.
- Brief description of communications, including reporting and reporting requirements:
    - Reporting formats
    - frequencies for service performance data and
    - relevant incident reports
- Contact details (name, phone number, email address) of people authorized to act in emergencies, to participate in incidents and problem correction, recovery, or workaround.
- Service hours, date exceptions (e.g., Weekends, public holidays), critical business periods, and out-of-hours cover.
- Scheduled and agreed interruptions, including notice to be given, number per period.
- Customer responsibilities, e.g., Security

- Service provider liability and obligations e.g., Security Impact and priority guidelines:
    - Escalation and notification procedure
    - Complaints handling procedure.
    - Service targets

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- Workload limits (upper and lower), e.g. The ability of the service to support the agreed number of users/volumes of work, system throughput.
- High-level financial management details, e.g., Service costs, etc.

- Problem management and disaster recovery procedures that may include:
  - Procedure to be followed to resolve unplanned incidents.
  - Prevention and reduction of unplanned incidents.
  - Documentation and logging procedure for reported incidents.
  - Action to be taken in the event of a serious disruption and
  - Problem escalation procedure.
  - Maintenance or review procedures.
  - Supporting and related services.
  - SLA change control mechanism; and
  - Any exceptions to the terms given in the SLA.
- The supporting services on which the delivered service depends will be documented and agreed upon with each supplier. This includes internal groups providing part of the service provider's service.
- The contents be formally agreed to and authorized by business owners and service provider representatives, communicated to all affected parties.

4. **Service Level reporting**

- The requirements for service reporting shall be agreed upon and recorded for third-party service providers.
- The following reports will be provided as defined in SLA with a third party (where applicable):
  - Reactive reports that show what has happened.
  - Proactive reports, which give warning of significant events, thereby enabling preventive action to be taken beforehand; and
  - Forward schedule reports showing planned activities. (E.g., Reports to highlight future and scheduled workloads.)
- Non-Disclosure Agreements should be signed off by the third parties

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- Respective team managers will maintain the *Issue Tracker* (XYZ-TS-IS-RG-013)to track issues related to Services provided by third parties. Actions will be taken to escalate those issues to authorized personnel representing the respective third-party service provider(s).
- Exception: When Vendors provide an issue tracker facility for their service, XYZ Holdings can use that issue tracker facility to track Issues instead of using the *Issue Tracker* (XYZ-TS-IS-RG-*013)*.

5. Monitoring Service Levels

Service level reports will be reviewed according to the following schedule/ frequency:

Reviewer	Type of Report	Frequency
Head of Infrastructure and Support	Periodic Reports	Quarterly

Should there be service levels not met or unsatisfactory, corrective actions will be taken by the Head of Infrastructure and Support.

6. Periodic SLA Review Procedure

The management in coordination with the Central IT Sourcing department will review the existing SLAs for relevance and appropriateness on an annual basis, depending on the period or terms of the SLAs.

Contents of the SLA may be amended as required. The SLA should be changed when events such as the following occur:

- The IT and operating environment have changed.
- The internal customer or XYZ Holdings' external customer/clients/service providers (for external SLA) expectations and/or needs have changed.
- The workloads have changed.
- Better metrics, measurement tools, and processes have evolved; and
- Other reasons that may improve the effectiveness of the service delivered or the SLA itself. After obtaining appropriate approvals, mutual agreement on the updated/modified SLA will be obtained and communicated to all affected parties by Central IT Sourcing.

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